

TAJARIN AL TARTUFO

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	4-6	45 min plus the dough rest

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
85 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
68 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	White truffle

METHOD

1. Cut 624 g of tajarin from the egg dough.
2. Put a large pot of water on to boil over high heat and salt it heavily.
3. Set a large saute pan over low heat and put in the butter with about two ladles of the pasta water, 115 g. Swirl the pan until it emulsifies, then take it off the heat.
4. Cook the tajarin 15 to 20 seconds. The strands are fine and go from raw to done almost at once.
5. Return the pan to low heat. Lift the pasta over with tongs or a pasta basket and raise the heat to medium. Toss it for 30 seconds to a minute so the pasta and sauce marry. A splash more pasta water loosens it if it tightens. It is ready when it clings with a gloss.
6. Off the heat, toss 45 g of the parmigiano through.
7. Divide into bowls, scatter the rest of the parmigiano over and shave truffle across each serving.

NOTES

Allow at least 5 g of white truffle per person, and nearer twice that if you have it to spare.
 The shavings need to be paper thin. A mandoline on its narrowest setting does the job without a truffle shaver.
 Tajarin is Piedmont's egg-rich take on tagliolini. Watch the pot — 20 seconds is the outer limit.
 Butter and pasta water are the whole sauce, so the emulsion in step 3 has to hold. Swirl until it looks creamy rather than split.

SHAPE

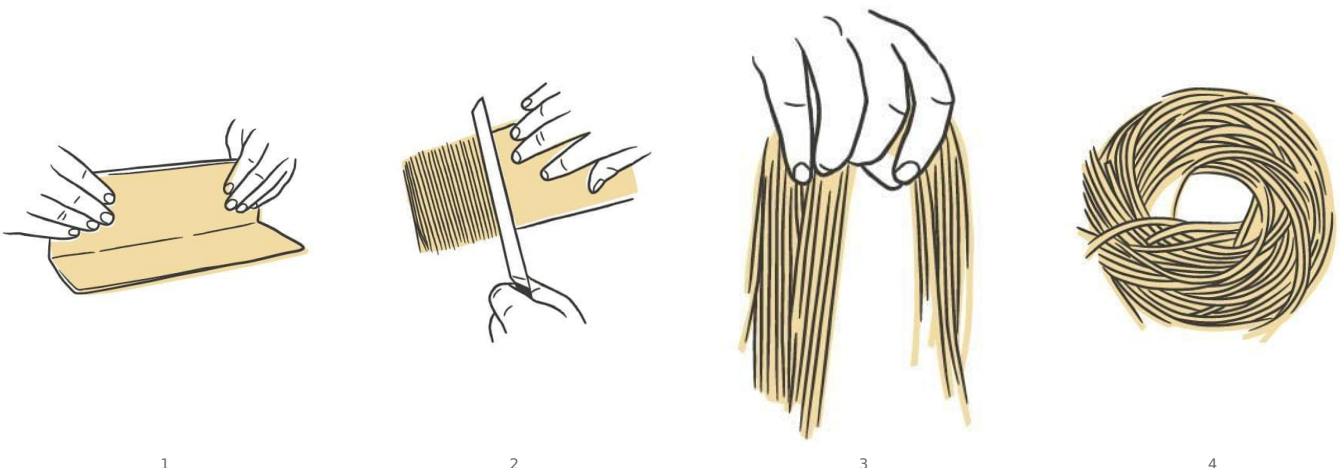
Tajarin

Region: Piedmont, particularly the Langhe hills south of Turin / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 18-inch lengths and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic or a towel.
4. Fold one sheet in half, then in thirds, until you have a packet about 4 1/2 by 6 inches. Turn it so the long side faces you and trim the ends. Cut 1/10-inch strands, working inward from one edge.
5. Dust the strands generously with 00 flour and shake them apart. Coil the batch into a nest on the pan.
6. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
7. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
8. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING





5

NOTES

Cut width is 1/10 inch, by hand off a folded packet. No cutter attachment.

Traditionally very yolk-heavy, anywhere from 20 to 40 yolks per kilo of 00 flour. Most cooks keep a separate dough for it. Robbins does not, because her standard egg dough is already yolk-only.

Same family as tagliolini and maccheroncini di Campofilone. All three are thin, rich egg ribbons that differ mainly in thickness and cutting method.

Coiled into a nest, not a horseshoe.

Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.

Alba white truffle is the famous pairing. It also takes butter and sage, a ragu, chicken-liver sauce, or the juices from roast meat, and is eaten year round.

DOUGH**Egg Dough**

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipó 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.

Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.

Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.

Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____
